Delhi. Earlier, Payas had confessed to Kanth that Kanagasabapathy and Athirai had made two trips to Delhi—first, to assassinate Rajiv Gandhi in case their plan in Madras failed, and second, when they were trying to figure out an escape route via Nepal.[2]

Parallel to these revelations, Radhavinod Raju was studying the diary of Sivarasan found in the kitchen hole of his Kodungaiyur hideout. At first, the tiny pages, with Tamil and English notes scrawled all over in Sivarasan's handwriting, hadn't thrown much light on events. It appeared to be a mix of telephone numbers, addresses, contact persons, aliases, code names and payments. Instead, the two pocket diaries were turning out to be the key to unlocking the conspiracy.

Raju had brought to Kaarthikeyan's notice that the notebook and the pocket diaries could be crucial evidence to proving the link between Sivarasan and the other assassins. After landing at Vedaranyam with the hit squad on 1 June, Sivarasan started jotting down the progress of work in these pocket diaries. A scrutiny of dates recorded indicated that he maintained them until two days after killing Rajiv Gandhi. He hid them in his Kodungaiyur hideout but it seems like he forgot to take them along when fleeing the place.

Sandeep Unnithan reported the details of the diary in a story in *India Today* much later. A salient part of his story was:

Dhanu wore a green-and-orange salwar kameez. During the journey to Sriperumbudur, Nalini recoiled in horror when Dhanu asked her to feel what was under her clothes. There were no metal detectors and no frisking at the venue. Nalini and Shubha escorted the human bomb Dhanu.

At 10.20 p.m. Rajiv Gandhi walked down a red carpet laid out at the grounds at Sriperumbudur. Rajiv, who looked tired, was welcomed by an enthusiastic crowd. Dhanu garlanded Rajiv and bent down as if to touch his feet. She flicked a switch on the right side of her garment to trigger off explosives in her bomb jacket. The blast instantly killed Rajiv Gandhi and seventeen others. In the melee, Sivarasan and his hit squad melted away.[3]

After going through Sivarasan's diary, it wasn't difficult for Raju and Kaarthikeyan to understand that the mastermind didn't want to be captured